MC 451 Definitions Practice rubric

25 points. Due Friday, October 16, 11:59 PM.

How this is scored. Add the points from each row; the total is out of 25. A first attempt is graded forgivingly: a part that is there but incomplete earns partial credit, and 0 is kept for a part that is missing. Scores on work that shows effort are adjusted with the course's curve: your final percentage is 25 percent plus 75 percent of your rubric percentage, so 50 of 100 on the rubric becomes 62.5. Submissions are unlimited before the deadline, so you can revise and submit again.

- Each row looks across all of your variables. Four variables done fully is the assignment; a fifth earns nothing extra.

Definitions Practice, 25 points

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Conceptual definition 4 points	**4 points.** Every variable says in one or two sentences what it means in the abstract: what it is meant to capture.	**3 points.** Every variable has one, but one or two read as a list of examples instead of saying what the variable captures.	**2 points.** Some variables have none, or the conceptual and operational definitions say the same thing.	**0 to 1 points.** Missing from most variables.
Operational definition 7 points	**7 points.** Every variable says exactly what a coder does to assign a value, with an action a coder performs (count, mark, check whether), clear enough that a stranger could follow it and reach your answer.	**5 to 6 points.** Every variable has a procedure, but at least one leaves a step to the coder's judgment, so two careful readers could follow it and disagree.	**4 points.** At least one operational definition repeats the conceptual one in different words. This is the mistake the assignment exists to catch: if it has no action a coder performs, it is not an operational definition yet.	**0 to 3 points.** Most variables have no procedure a coder could follow.
Level of measurement 3 points	**3 points.** Named for every variable (nominal, ordinal, interval or ratio), and it matches the coded values.	**2 points.** Named for every variable, but one does not match its values (for example, ordered values called nominal).	**1 point.** Named for some variables only.	**0 points.** Missing.

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Coded values 4 points	**4 points.** Every value is listed with what it means, and every item fits exactly one value, including an "other" or "none" value where one is needed.	**3 points.** Values are listed with meanings, but one variable has no place for items that fit none of them, or two values overlap.	**2 points.** Values are listed without saying what each means, or the list trails off ("etc.").	**0 to 1 points.** Missing for most variables.
Edge-case decision rules 7 points	**7 points.** Every variable has at least two edge cases, each written as a rule a coder can apply ("Emote-only messages are coded 0"), drawn from cases that come up in your material.	**5 to 6 points.** Two per variable, but at least one is an intention ("be careful with sarcasm") instead of a rule.	**4 points.** Some variables have one edge case or none.	**0 to 3 points.** No rules, or intentions only.

Before you submit

Codebook Check reads a pasted definition block and reports which variables are missing a conceptual or an operational definition, a level of measurement, or a catch-all category. It does not grade, and nothing you enter leaves your machine.